

James Barruga

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Summary

Self-taught AI engineer building production automation systems end-to-end: cold-email pipelines with human-in-the-loop safety, AI voice agents for SMBs, video orchestration, and multi-role enterprise dashboards. Comfortable across n8n, Python, Next.js, Playwright, and the major LLM / voice / vision APIs. Bias for shipping working software over architecture diagrams.

Selected Projects

Cold Email Automation Pipeline — JoNeX Agency Production cold-outreach system: lead enrichment, AI-personalized drafts, Telegram approval gate, manual Gmail send. Built with n8n, Python, Telegram Bot API, Gmail API, SQLite. Currently in active use. [github.com/jamesbarruga/cold-email-automation]

AI Voice Receptionist 24/7 AI inbound phone agent for SMBs. ElevenLabs Conversational AI + Twilio telephony + n8n business logic + ServiceM8 CRM. Built end-to-end for a logistics client. [github.com/jamesbarruga/ai-voice-receptionist]

Lead Prospecting Toolkit B2B lead generation toolkit with anti-bot evasion: multi-source discovery, contact extraction, MX validation, lead scoring. Playwright + Python. Beats paid alternatives (Apify, Firecrawl) on cost and long-tail coverage. [github.com/jamesbarruga/leadgen-prospecting-toolkit]

AI Video Pipeline n8n orchestrator turning a news topic into a finished short-form documentary segment. Verification layer + script generation + Higgsfield visuals + Shotstack assembly. Built for a documentary production client. [github.com/jamesbarruga/ai-video-pipeline]

Microfinance OS Demo Multi-role operations dashboard for microfinance NGOs: six role-shaped surfaces (exec, ops, field officer mobile, finance, donor, admin) sharing one data layer, instead of one dashboard with role filters. [github.com/jamesbarruga/microfinance-os-demo]

Money Truth Cockpit Finance reconciliation dashboard that surfaces revenue/expense mismatches across sources in a single view. Live demo. [jamesbarruga.github.io/clipt-money-truth-cockpit]

Experience

JoNeX Agency — AI Automation Developer January 2026 – Present

- Built and shipped the agency's cold-email outreach pipeline (n8n + Python + Telegram approval gate + Gmail draft).
- Delivered an AI voice receptionist (ElevenLabs + Twilio + n8n) for an SMB client.
- Built lead-prospecting toolkit (Playwright + Python) replacing paid Apify/Firecrawl spend.
- Designed and prototyped the agency's mobile-commerce creative studio (Next.js + Higgsfield).

Independent Projects — 2024 – Present

- Designed and built a microfinance operations dashboard concept (multi-role architecture) currently in conversation with a microfinance NGO.
 - Built a finance reconciliation dashboard published as a public demo.
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Skills

Languages & Runtimes: Python, JavaScript / TypeScript, HTML / CSS, Bash **Orchestration & Workflow:** n8n, webhooks, cron / scheduled jobs **Web:** Next.js, vanilla HTML + Tailwind, GitHub Pages **AI / APIs:** OpenAI, vision LLMs, ElevenLabs

Conversational AI, Higgsfield, Shotstack **Integrations:** Gmail API, Telegram Bot API, Twilio, ServiceM8, Google Workspace
Automation & Scraping: Playwright (incl. anti-bot patterns), MX validation **Data:** SQLite, CSV pipelines, lead scoring
Tooling: Git, GitHub CLI, gh Actions, macOS dev environment

Approach

Production-first. Every project ships with a human-in-the-loop safety gate where the cost of a wrong action is high (cold email sends, voice calls, financial reconciliation). I write small focused systems that I can debug in one sitting, prefer config-driven over hardcoded, and instrument everything I deploy.

References available on request.